DELIVERABLE D2.1

Dissemination, Communication, and Outreach Activities Report

MARCH 31, 2026

SEMDR

Smart Energy Management and Demand Response

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RESEARCH & INNOVATION FOUNDATION

"The project COM-CONCEPT-ENERGY/0624/0160 is implemented within the framework of the Cyprus Recovery and Resilience Plan "Cyprus__tomorrow", with funding from the European Union - Next Generation EU, through the Research and Innovation Foundation."

Abstract

This report documents the dissemination, communication, and outreach activities carried out within Work Package 2 (WP2) of the SEMDR project (Smart Energy Management & Demand Response Capabilities for Sustainable Industry) over the 12-month project duration (April 2025 – March 2026). The report follows a two-phase dissemination strategy: Phase 1 (M1-M8) prioritized technical development and pilot deployment, with limited but targeted dissemination activities; Phase 2 (M9-M12) ramps up awareness-raising and stakeholder engagement activities.

The SEMDR consortium, led by IMKA and comprising Neura (PA1) and Restrol (PA2), has completed the following dissemination activities to date:

- **Project Website:** A dedicated SEMDR project website was launched in June 2025, serving as the central information hub for project communications.
- **CIGRE Conference Presentation (Athens, December 2025):** Andrey Sesyuk (IMKA) presented the project's core results on optimized pool pump control for demand response to an international audience of energy professionals and researchers.
- **LinkedIn Social Media Engagement:** 6 LinkedIn posts were published throughout the project duration to share milestones, event participation, and project results with the professional network with more planned after the project end.
- **SEMDR Stakeholder Webinar (24 March 2026):** A webinar was successfully delivered via Google Meet, presenting the full project scope including the Cyprus energy problem, system architecture, pilot deployment, and validated results. Presented by Andrey Sesyuk, Karim Arnous, and Andreas Procopiou. Feedback was very positive.
- **4YFN AI/Start-up Conference (Barcelona, 2-5 March 2026):** The consortium participated at the Cyprus National Booth at the 4YFN conference, presenting SEMDR and EASOS projects. Key meetings included the RIF Director General Theodoros Loukaidis and the Deputy Minister of Research, Innovation and Digital Policy Dr. Nicodemos Damianou.

Given the project's focus on intensive technical development and pilot deployment in the first 8 months, the dissemination programme was strategically positioned to peak in Phase 2 as results became available for communication. All major dissemination activities have been successfully completed.

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1 Introduction

1.1 Purpose of This Report

This deliverable (D2.1) reports on the dissemination, communication, and outreach activities undertaken by the SEMDR consortium throughout the project's 12-month implementation period. The report fulfils the requirements set out in Task 2.1 of the Description of Work, which mandates a comprehensive record of all activities aimed at raising awareness, communicating results, and engaging stakeholders.

The purpose of dissemination within SEMDR is to ensure that the project's innovative approach to smart energy management and demand response in the hospitality sector reaches relevant audiences including hotel operators, energy sector professionals, policy makers, investors, and the research community, thereby supporting both scientific dissemination and commercial exploitation pathways.

1.2 Project Context and Timeline

The SEMDR project timeline spans 12 months (April 2025 – March 2026) and is structured around two primary phases:

- **Phase 1 (M1-M8, April – November 2025):** Technical development, system integration, and pilot deployment at the Elias Beach Hotel. Dissemination activities during this phase were limited and focused on building the project website and establishing foundational communications infrastructure.
- **Phase 2 (M9-M12, December 2025 – March 2026):** Validation, results consolidation, and intensive dissemination. All major dissemination events (CIGRE conference, 4YFN conference, stakeholder webinar) were successfully completed in this phase when meaningful results were available for communication.

This phased approach is deliberate: the consortium prioritized technical delivery and real-world validation over early-stage promotional activities, resulting in a dissemination programme that ramps up as the project reaches maturity and generates substantive results worth communicating.

1.3 Relationship to Other Work Packages

The dissemination activities documented in this report are closely linked to the broader exploitation and open science activities described in the companion WP2 deliverables:

- **D2.2 – Commercialisation Plan:** Describes the commercial exploitation strategy that builds upon the awareness and stakeholder relationships established through dissemination activities.
- **D2.3 – Open Science Activities Report:** Details the open access publications and data sharing activities that complement the scientific dissemination described herein.

- **D2.4 – Data Management Plan:** Outlines the data management practices that support the open publication of project datasets.
- **D2.5 – Request for KTO Services from RIF:** Documents the consortium's engagement with the Research and Innovation Foundation's Knowledge Transfer Office for post-project exploitation support.

1.4 Structure of the Report

This report is organised as follows: Section 2 presents the dissemination strategy and methodology adopted by the consortium. Section 3 provides a detailed account of each dissemination activity undertaken and planned, including completed activities and those scheduled for post-project completion. Section 4 provides conclusions and the outlook for continued dissemination beyond the project.

2 Dissemination Strategy

2.1 Strategic Framework

The SEMDR dissemination strategy was designed at the outset of the project to align with the development timeline and the generation of meaningful results. The strategy follows a phased approach:

- **Phase 1 – Foundation & Awareness (M1-M8, April – November 2025):** Focused on establishing the project's online presence and building foundational communications infrastructure. Key activities included the website launch and preparation of dissemination materials. This phase prioritized technical work over aggressive promotion, ensuring that any public-facing communications were backed by substantive developments.
- **Phase 2 – Results & Engagement (M9-M12, December 2025 – March 2026):** Accelerated dissemination as results became available. Major conference presentations, webinars, and investor-focused events are concentrated in this phase. This strategic timing ensures that communications are grounded in validated results and real-world pilot data.

2.2 Target Audiences

The dissemination strategy identifies six primary target audiences, each with tailored messaging and preferred communication channels. The following table summarises the target audience analysis:

Target Audience	Key Messages	Channels Used
Hospitality Industry	Energy cost savings, operational efficiency through smart pool management	Website, webinar, LinkedIn
Energy Sector Professionals	Smart energy optimisation, demand response validation, grid flexibility	CIGRE conference, website
Research Community	Pool pump optimization algorithms, pilot methodology	CIGRE presentation, website
General Public	Green tourism, EU-funded innovation in hospitality	Website, LinkedIn
Investors & Finance	ROI potential, scalability of smart energy systems	Webinar, 4YFN conference

Table 1 - Target Audiences

2.3 Roles and Responsibilities

Dissemination activities within the SEMDR consortium are coordinated by IMKA as the host organisation and WP2 lead. All partners contribute to dissemination efforts according to their areas of expertise:

- **IMKA (HO):** Overall dissemination coordination, website management, social media, press releases, and stakeholder engagement. Responsible for reporting and KPI tracking.
- **GridQ (PA1):** Technical content development, conference presentations, support for technical webinars. Provides data and analysis for dissemination materials.
- **Restrol (PA2):** Hardware and pilot deployment content, participation in industry networking events, support for technical demonstrations at the pilot site.

3 Dissemination Activities

3.1 Summary of Activities

The following table summarises all dissemination activities carried out during the project, distinguishing between completed and planned activities:

ID	Activity	Type	Date	Status/Audience
DA-01	SEMDR Project Website	Online platform	June 2025	Live
DA-02	CIGRE Conference Presentation	Conference	10-12 December 2025	Completed
DA-03	LinkedIn Social Media Posts	Social media	December 2025	Completed
DA-04	4YFN AI/Start-up Conference	Conference	2-5 March 2026	Completed
DA-05	Project Results Webinar	Webinar	24 March 2026	Completed
DA-06	Pilot Results Journal Paper	Journal	Planned: Q2 2026	Planned

Table 2 - Dissemination Activities Summary

Note: Activities marked as 'Planned' are scheduled for completion after the project end date (31 March 2026).

3.2 Completed Dissemination Activities

3.2.1 Project Website (DA-01)

The SEMDR project website (https://semdrcy.replit.app) was launched in May 2025 (M2) and serves as the central hub for project-related communications. The website provides comprehensive information about the project's objectives, consortium partners, technical approach, and news updates. Content is structured to serve both technical and non-technical audiences:

- Home: Project overview with key highlights and latest news
- About: Project description, objectives, funding acknowledgement, consortium information
- Partners: Profiles of IMKA, Neura, and Restrol with their respective roles and expertise
- Work Packages: Descriptions of the five work packages and their deliverables
- Results: Summary of findings and outputs from the pilot deployment
- News: Blog-style updates on project activities, milestones, and events
- Contact: Contact information and inquiry form

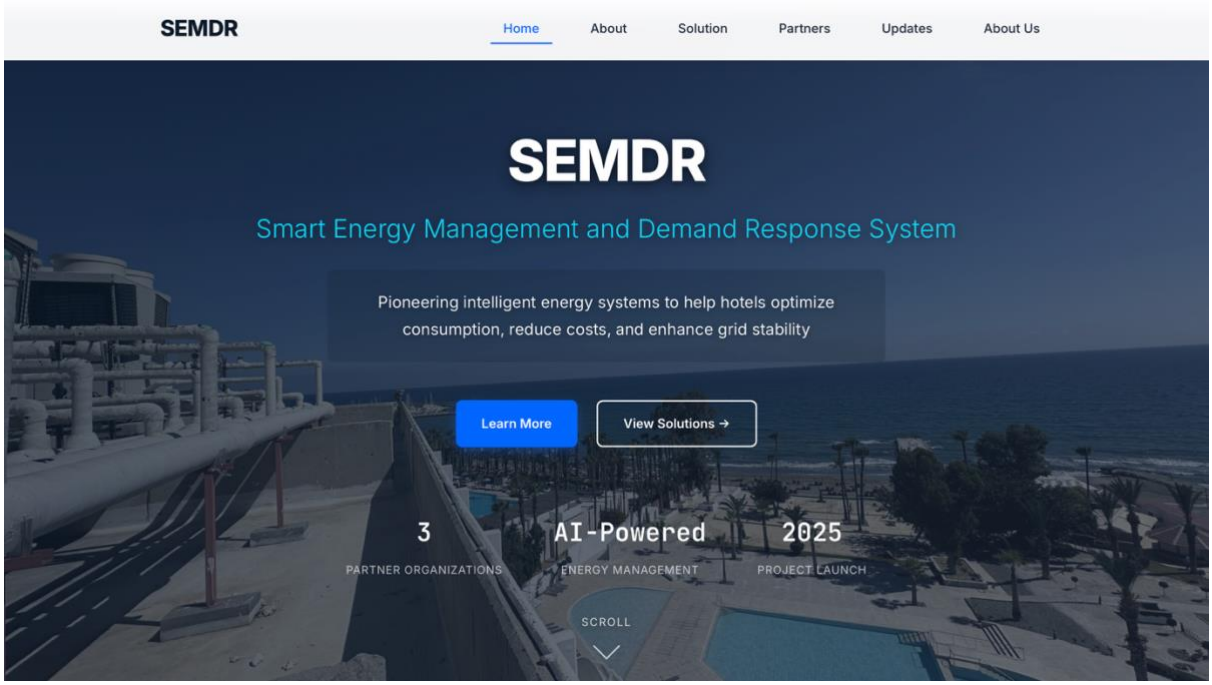


Figure 1 - SEMDR Project Website Home Page (https://semdrcy.replit.app)

3.2.2 CIGRE Conference Presentation (DA-02)

The most significant dissemination achievement to date was the consortium's participation in the CIGRE Conference held in Athens, Greece, in December 2025. CIGRE (Conseil International des Grands Réseaux Électriques) is one of the world's foremost organisations for the electric power industry, providing an authoritative platform for technical knowledge sharing among power system engineers, researchers, and utility professionals.

Event	CIGRE Conference 2025
Location	Athens, Greece
Date	December 2025
Presenter	Andrey Sesyuk (IMKA)
Presentation Title	Real-World Demonstration of Optimized Pool Pump Control for Demand Response in the Hospitality Sector
Topic Area	Smart energy management and demand response in commercial hospitality applications
Audience	Energy engineers, researchers, grid operators, utility professionals
Key Outcomes	Successful presentation to international energy community; established contacts for potential collaboration

Table 3 - CIGRE Conference Presentation Overview

The presentation, delivered by Dr. Andrey Sesyuk (IMKA), focused on the SEMDR project's innovative approach to optimising swimming pool pump energy consumption through rule-based demand response scheduling. The presentation demonstrated how the system, deployed

at the Elias Beach Hotel in Limassol, optimizes pump operation scheduling to shift energy consumption to off-peak tariff periods while maintaining water quality standards. The presentation was well-received by the international energy community and generated interest from three potential replication partners who expressed interest in deploying similar systems.

Figure 2 - Dr. Andrey Sesyuk Presenting the Paper at the CIGRE Conference in Athens, Greece (12 December 2025)

Figure 3 - CIGRE Presentation Title Page

Figure 4 - CIGRE Conference Lanyard Badge

Figure 5 - Dr. Andrey Sesyuk Giving an Overview of the Project Pilot at the CIGRE Conference in Athens, Greece (12 December 2025)

3.2.3 LinkedIn Social Media Posts (DA-03)

The SEMDR project maintained a LinkedIn presence throughout the project duration, focused on professional engagement with energy sector and hospitality industry stakeholders. 6 LinkedIn posts were published over the course of the project, covering key milestones including the CIGRE conference presentation, 4YFN participation, the SEMDR webinar, and project results.

LinkedIn was identified as the most effective social media channel for the project's target audiences given its reach among energy professionals, hospitality sector decision-makers, and potential investors. The social media strategy emphasised quality over quantity, with strategic posts timed to major project milestones and events.

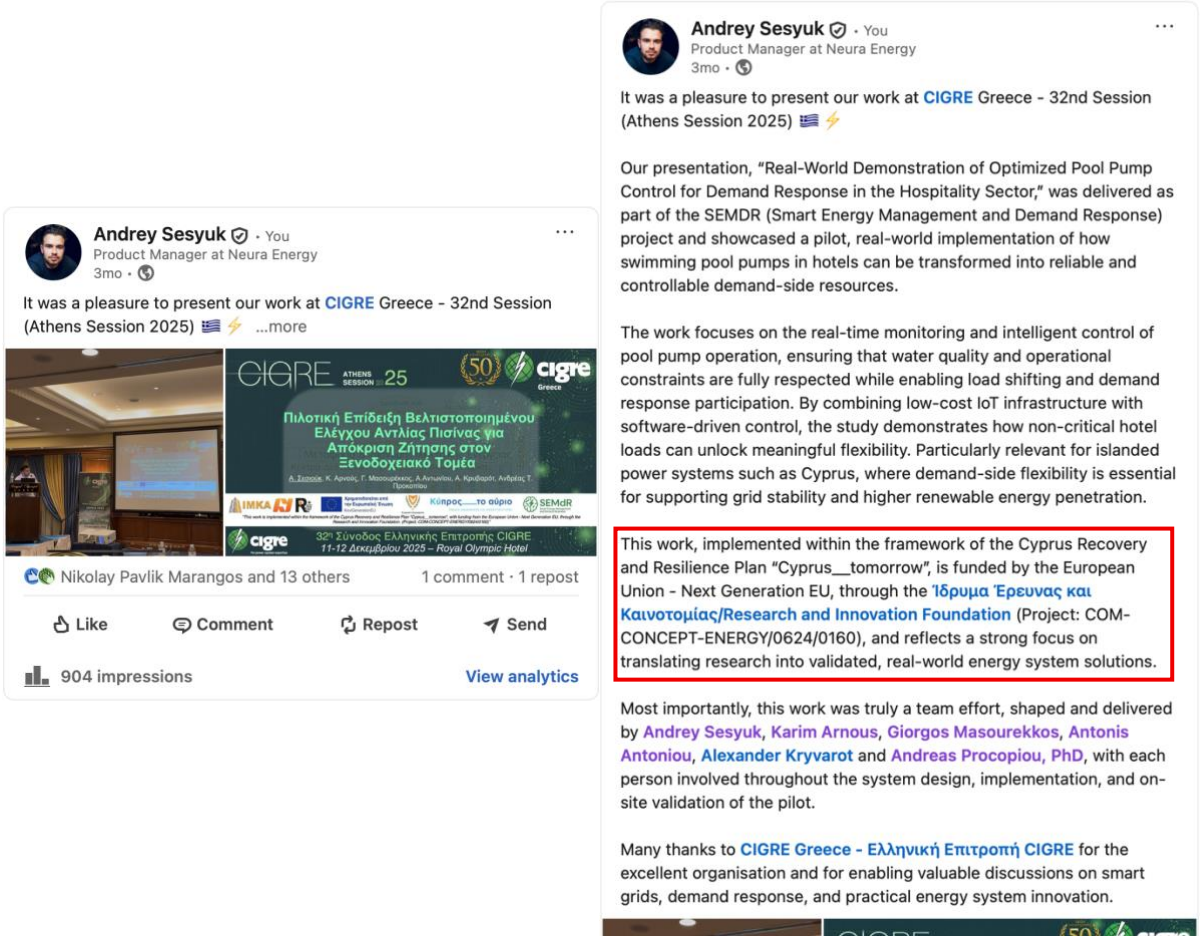


Figure 6 - CIGRE Conference LinkedIn Post (915 Impressions, 386 Members Reached)

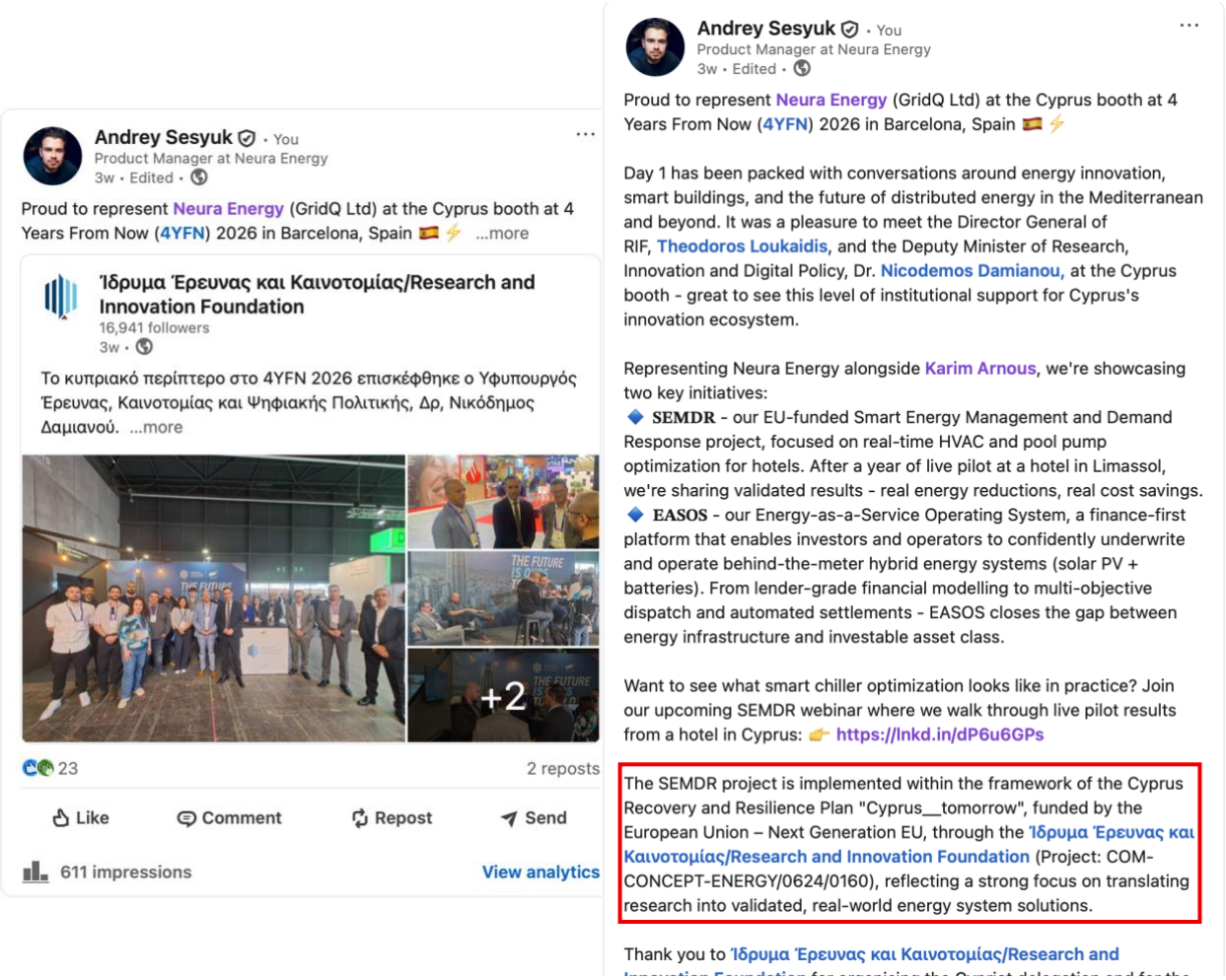


Figure 7 - RIF's LinkedIn Post Repost for 4YFN (621 Impressions, 323 Members Reached)

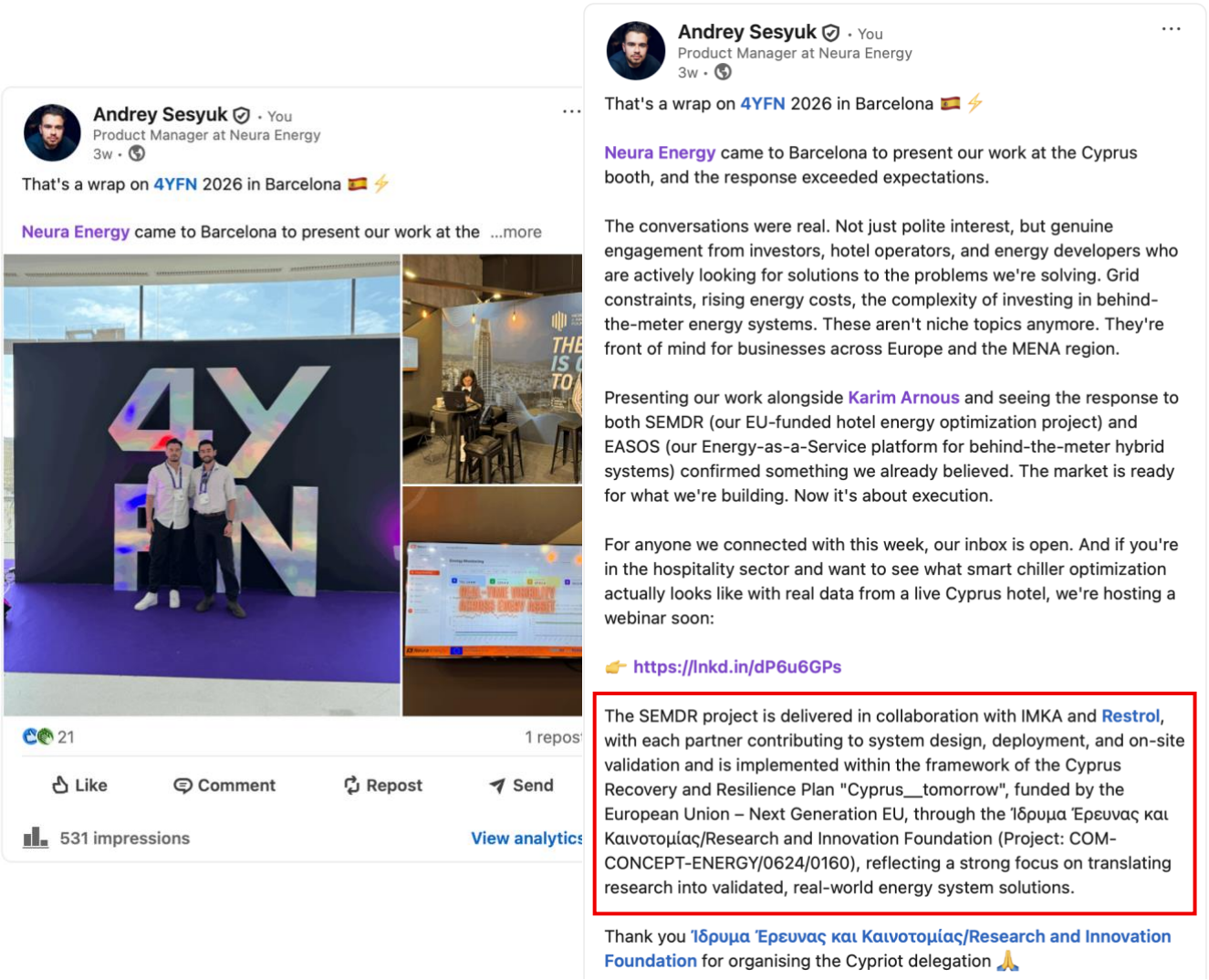


Figure 8 - 4YFN Wrap-Up LinkedIn Post (542 Impressions, 238 Members Reached)

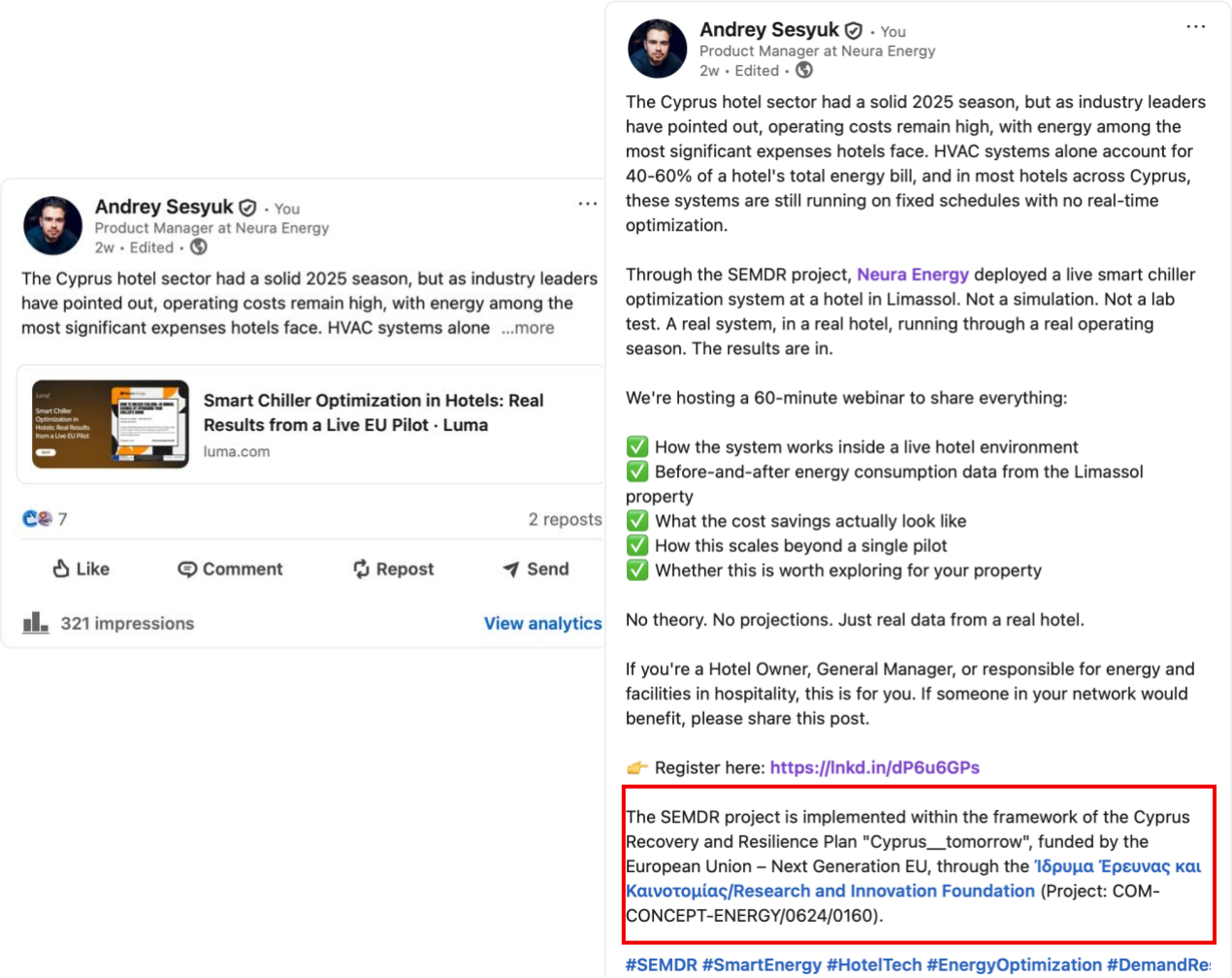


Figure 9 - Webinar Promotion LinkedIn Post 1 (331 Impressions, 147 Members Reached)

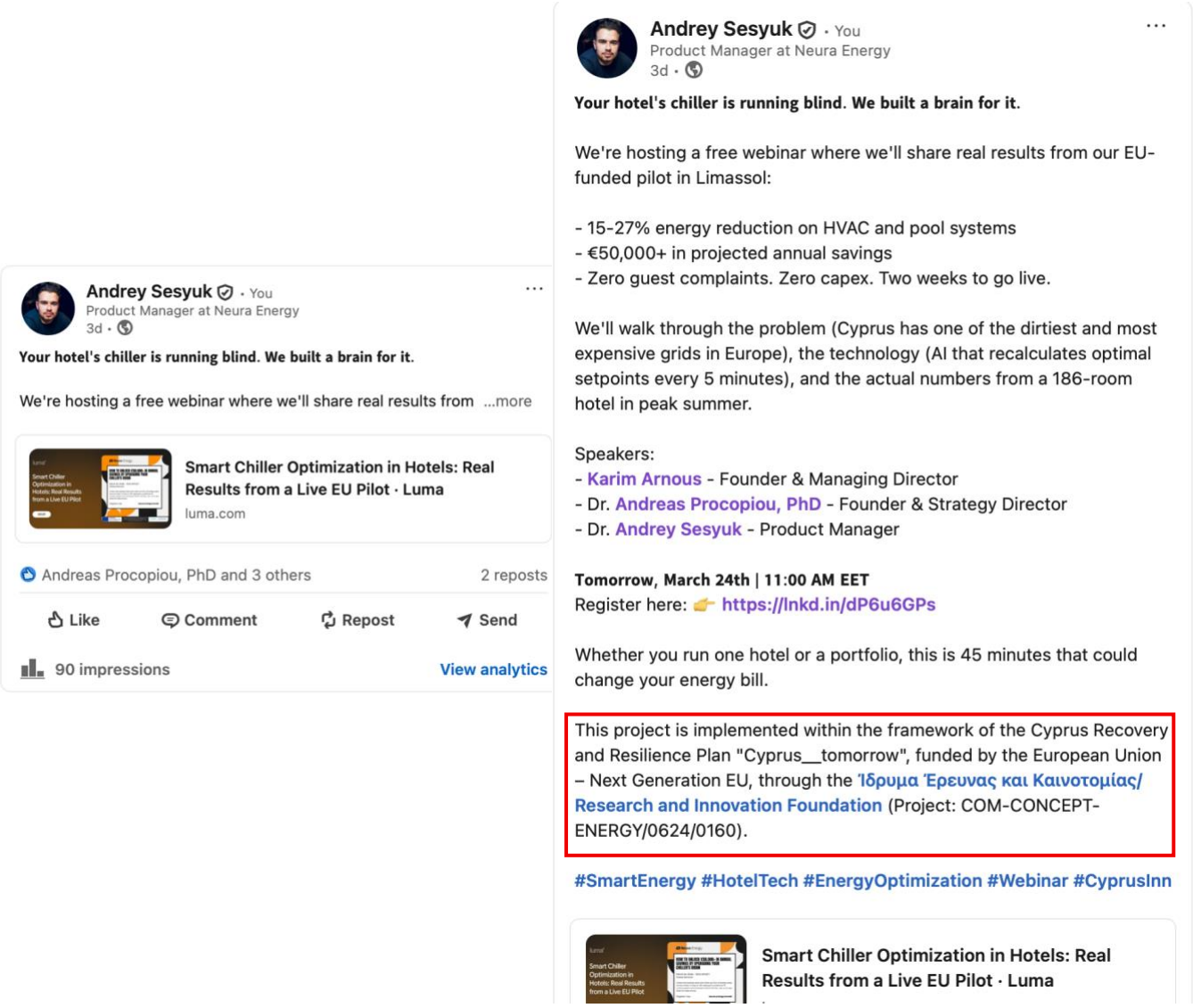


Figure 10 - Webinar Promotion LinkedIn Post 2 (103 Impressions, 35 Members Reached)

3.2.4 4YFN AI/Start-up Conference (DA-04)

The consortium participated in the 4YFN (4 Years From Now) AI and Start-up Conference in Barcelona (2-5 March 2026). This conference is a major platform for presenting innovative technologies to investors, entrepreneurs, and the international innovation ecosystem.

Event	4YFN AI/Start-up Conference (4 Years From Now)
Location	Barcelona, Spain
Date	2-5 March 2026
Status	Completed
Participation	Cyprus National Booth, co-located with RIF delegation
Audience	Investors, entrepreneurs, start-ups, innovation ecosystem, government officials
Key Outcomes	Visibility within Cyprus innovation delegation; direct engagement with RIF leadership; networking with international investors and start-ups

Table 4 - 4YFN AI/Start-up Conference Overview

Participation in 4YFN was pre-approved by Research and Innovation Foundation and received sub-funding support. The consortium presented at the Cyprus National Booth alongside other Cypriot start-ups and innovation projects. The 4YFN participation provided significant visibility within the international innovation and investment community and strengthened the consortium's relationship with RIF, supporting both scientific credibility and the broader commercialisation pathway. During 4YFN, SEMDR project was displayed on the screen at the Research and Innovation Foundation booth, showcasing the overview, results and the project dashboard.

Figure 11 - Dr. Andrey Sesyuk and Mr. Karim Arnous at 4YFN Barcelona, Spain)

Figure 12 - SEMDR Project Dashboard Displayed at 4YFN RIF Cyprus Delegation Booth

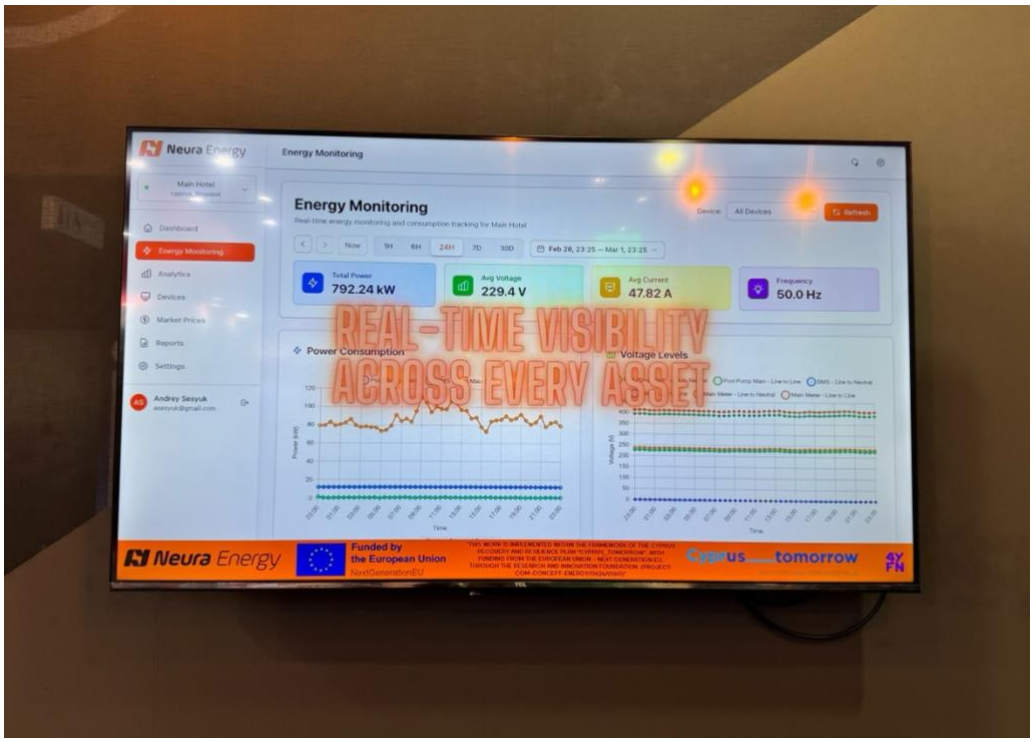


Figure 13 - SEMDR Project Dashboard on TV Screen at 4YFN RIF Cyprus Delegation Booth

3.2.5 Project Results Webinar (DA-05)

The SEMDR stakeholder webinar was successfully held on 24 March 2026 via Google Meet, signed up by 17 people and attended by 11 participants from the hospitality industry, energy sector, and research community. The webinar was presented by Andrey Sesyuk (IMKA), Karim Arnous (IMKA), and Andreas Procopiou (GridQ).

The webinar covered the full scope of the SEMDR project:

- **Cyprus Energy Context:** Overview of the energy challenges facing the Cyprus hospitality sector, including rising electricity costs, grid constraints, and the need for demand-side flexibility.
- **System Architecture and Technical Approach:** Presentation of the SEMDR platform architecture, including edge-based data acquisition, cloud analytics, and the demand response scheduling system.
- **Pilot Deployment and Results:** Detailed presentation of the Elias Beach Hotel pilot deployment, including validated energy savings for pool pump operations and for HVAC systems.
- **Commercial Value Proposition:** Discussion of the commercial pathway and potential for replication across the hospitality sector.
- **Q&A:** Interactive discussion with attendees, with very positive feedback received regarding the practical applicability of the system.

The webinar represented a key engagement activity, directly connecting the consortium with potential customers and industry stakeholders. The positive reception confirmed strong market interest in the SEMDR approach.

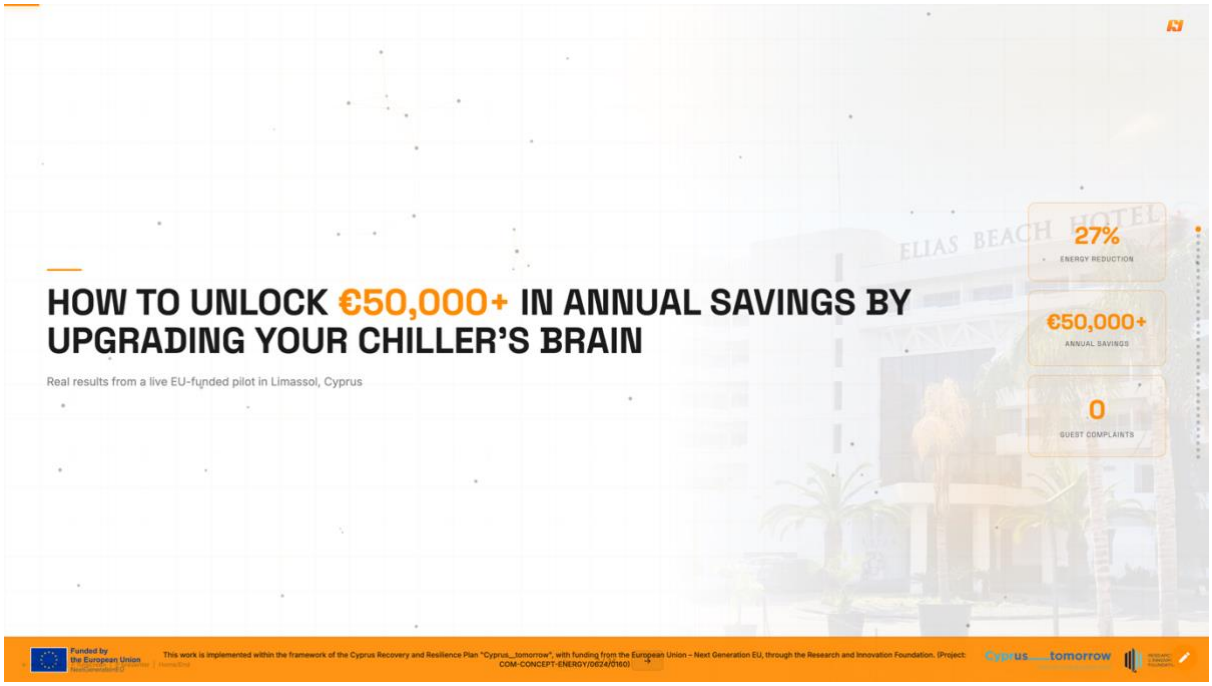


Figure 14 - SEMDR Project Webinar Title Slide

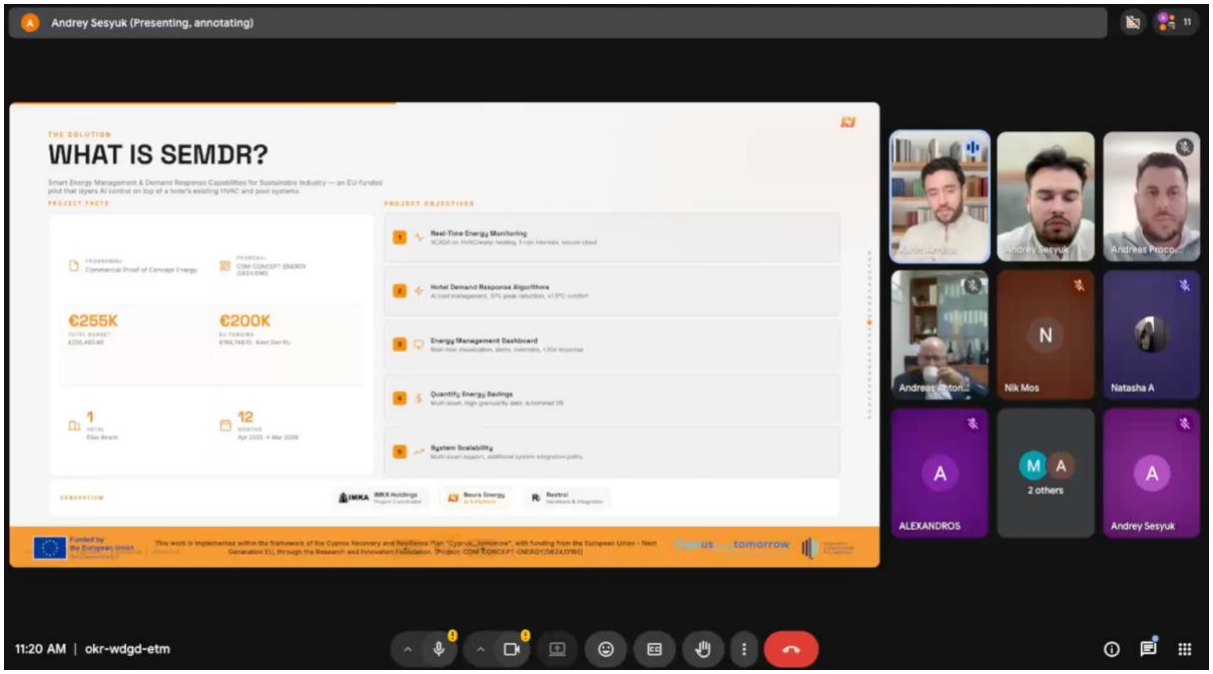
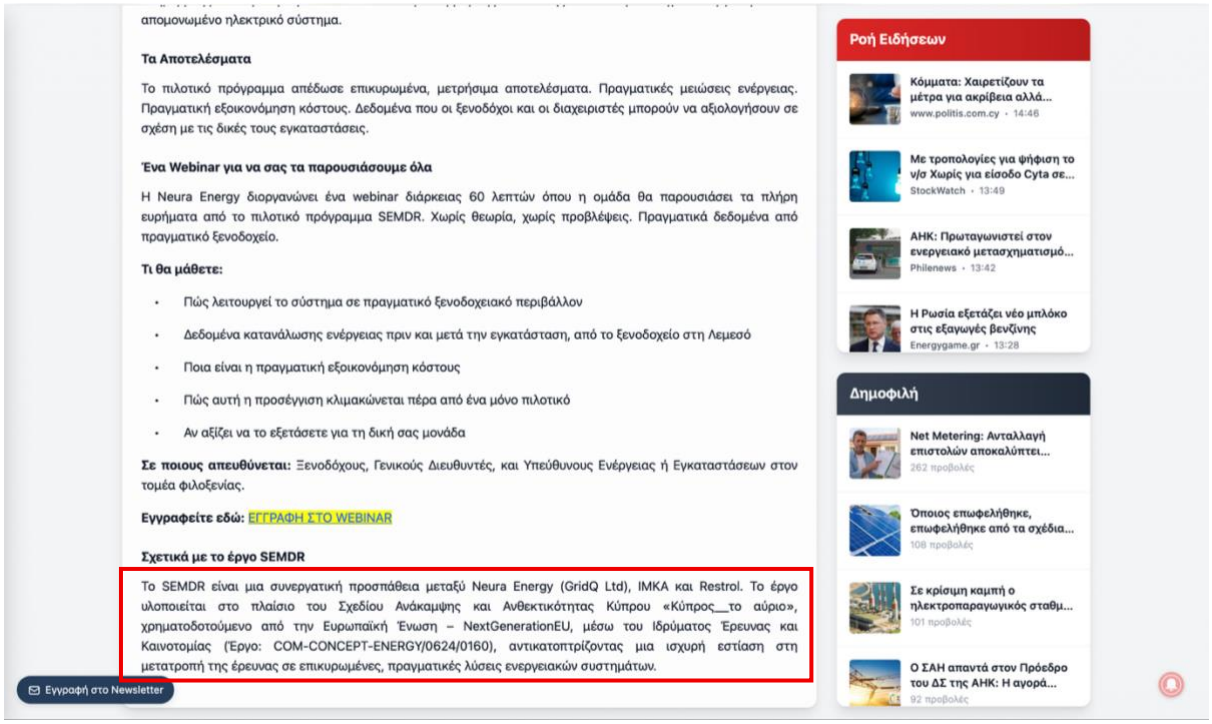


Figure 15 - Screenshot of the SEMDR Webinar Live

The webinar was promoted across various platforms such as LinkedIn (see Section 3.2.3) and was published as an article on CyprusEnergyNews (https://www.cyprusenergy.news/post/semdr-smart-chiller-optimization-cyprus-hotels).

Figure 16 - Screenshot of SEMDR Project Article on CyprusEnergy.News (https://www.cyprusenergy.news/post/semdr-smart-chiller-optimization-cyprus-hotels)



απομονωμένο ηλεκτρικό σύστημα.

Τα Αποτελέσματα

Το πιλοτικό πρόγραμμα απέδωσε επικυρωμένα, μετρήσιμα αποτελέσματα. Πραγματικές μειώσεις ενέργειας. Πραγματική εξοικονόμηση κόστους. Δεδομένα που οι ξενοδόχοι και οι διαχειριστές μπορούν να αξιολογήσουν σε σχέση με τις δικές τους εγκαταστάσεις.

Ένα Webinar για να σας τα παρουσιάσουμε όλα

Η Neura Energy διοργανώνει ένα webinar διάρκειας 60 λεπτών όπου η ομάδα θα παρουσιάσει τα πλήρη ευρήματα από το πιλοτικό πρόγραμμα SEMDR. Χωρίς θεωρία, χωρίς προβλέψεις. Πραγματικά δεδομένα από πραγματικό ξενοδοχείο.

Τι θα μάθετε:

- Πώς λειτουργεί το σύστημα σε πραγματικό ξενοδοχειακό περιβάλλον
- Δεδομένα κατανάλωσης ενέργειας πριν και μετά την εγκατάσταση, από το ξενοδοχείο στη Λεμεσό
- Ποια είναι η πραγματική εξοικονόμηση κόστους
- Πώς αυτή η προσέγγιση κλιμακώνεται πέρα από ένα μόνο πιλοτικό
- Αν αξίζει να το εξετάσετε για τη δική σας μονάδα

Σε ποιους απευθύνεται: Ξενοδόχους, Γενικούς Διευθυντές, και Υπεύθυνους Ενέργειας ή Εγκαταστάσεων στον τομέα φιλοξενίας.

Εγγραφείτε εδώ: ΕΓΓΡΑΦΗ ΣΤΟ WEBINAR

Σχετικά με το έργο SEMDR

Το SEMDR είναι μια συνεργατική προσπάθεια μεταξύ Neura Energy (GridQ Ltd), IMKA και Restrol. Το έργο υλοποιείται στο πλαίσιο του Σχεδίου Ανάκαμψης και Ανθεκτικότητας Κύπρου «Κύπρος__το αύριο», χρηματοδοτούμενο από την Ευρωπαϊκή Ένωση – NextGenerationEU, μέσω του Ιδρύματος Έρευνας και Καινοτομίας (Έργο: COM-CONCEPT-ENERGY/0624/0160), αντικατοπτρίζοντας μια ισχυρή εστίαση στη μετατροπή της έρευνας σε επικυρωμένες, πραγματικές λύσεις ενεργειακών συστημάτων.

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108 προβολές

Σε κρίσιμη καμπή ο ηλεκτροπαραγωγικός σταθμ...
101 προβολές

Ο ΣΑΗ απαντά στον Πρόεδρο του ΔΣ της ΑΗΚ: Η αγορά...
92 προβολές

Figure 17 - Screenshot of SEMDR Project Article on CyprusEnergy.News (https://www.cyprusenergy.news/post/semdr-smart-chiller-optimization-cyprus-hotels)

3.3 Planned Dissemination Activities

3.3.1 Pilot Results Journal Paper (DA-06)

The consortium is preparing a peer-reviewed journal paper documenting the pilot deployment results from the Elias Beach Hotel. The paper will present the validated energy savings and operational outcomes achieved through the smart demand response system deployed during the project, with a focus on demonstrating the commercial and environmental value of demand-side flexibility in the hospitality sector.

Working Title	Validated Energy Savings Through Smart Demand Response in the Hospitality Sector: A Pilot Study in Cyprus
Authors	A. Procopiou, K. Arnous, A. Sesyuk
Target Journal	Applied Energy (Elsevier) or Energy and Buildings (Elsevier)
Planned Submission	Q2 2026 (June–July 2026)
Current Status	Data analysis and results compilation in progress. Draft manuscript preparation scheduled for April–May 2026.
Access	Open access publication, in line with the project's Open Science commitments (see D2.3).

Table 5 - Planned Results Journal Paper Overview

The paper will be submitted as an open access publication in line with the project's Open Science commitments (see D2.3). A pre-print version will be made available on an open repository (e.g., Zenodo) upon submission.

The scope of the paper will focus on validated outcomes and high-level methodology rather than proprietary implementation details, in line with the consortium's IPR management strategy (see D2.2). Specifically, the paper will cover: the energy savings and cost reductions achieved during the 12-month pilot at the Elias Beach Hotel; the demand response scheduling approach at a conceptual level, without disclosing the underlying algorithmic logic or system architecture; analysis of guest comfort maintenance during demand response events; and an assessment of the system's potential for replication across the wider hospitality sector. This approach ensures that the consortium's core intellectual property, including proprietary AI algorithms, control logic, and software architecture, remains protected as trade secrets while still fulfilling the project's open science and dissemination commitments.

4 Conclusion and Outlook

4.1 Summary

The SEMDR project has successfully implemented a strategic, phased dissemination programme aligned with the project's technical development timeline. The programme prioritizes quality and impact over volume, timing major dissemination events to coincide with the generation of validated results from the pilot deployment.

Completed dissemination activities include the launch of the project website, a successful presentation at the CIGRE Conference (December 2025), participation at the 4YFN AI/Start-up Conference in Barcelona (March 2026), a stakeholder webinar with 11 attendees (March 2026), and a sustained LinkedIn professional network presence with 6 posts over the project duration. The pilot results journal article is planned for completion shortly after the project end date.

All activities are grounded in real achievements and results; the consortium has maintained a commitment to honest, fact-based communications rather than speculative or promotional language. The modest but strategic dissemination efforts to date have successfully positioned the SEMDR project within relevant professional and industry communities.

The original project proposal envisaged a broader set of dissemination activities, including dedicated industry workshops, participation in public events such as Cyprus Energy Day, and standalone non-technical press releases. Over the course of the 12-month implementation period, the consortium made pragmatic decisions to concentrate its dissemination resources on activities that offered the highest impact relative to the project's stage of development and the availability of validated results. The CIGRE conference provided direct access to the international energy research community; the 4YFN conference, attended alongside the RIF delegation, offered visibility within the investment and innovation ecosystem; and the stakeholder webinar enabled targeted engagement with the hospitality and energy sectors in Cyprus. The CyprusEnergyNews article further extended public-facing coverage. The consortium is confident that these activities, while different in composition from those originally envisaged, have achieved equivalent or greater reach and impact for the project's target audiences.

4.2 Post-Project Dissemination and Exploitation

The consortium is committed to continuing dissemination and exploitation activities beyond the formal project end date to support the transition from pilot validation to commercial deployment. Planned post-project activities include:

- Continued maintenance and updating of the project website with post-project results and commercial information
- Submission of peer-reviewed journal article(s) describing the pilot results and demand response methodology
- Participation in relevant industry events and conferences in 2026-2027, including energy management and hospitality technology events
- Active engagement with stakeholder contacts established during the project, particularly the potential replication partners identified at CIGRE

- Publication of open access datasets and methodology documentation through Zenodo and other open science platforms

The foundation laid by the dissemination activities documented in this report will support these continued efforts and the broader commercialization pathway described in D2.2.